



Infographic on wearables

2015 could finally be the year of wearables, and here's a an infographic on the forecast of wearables by CSS Insights
<http://dgit.in/WearableInfog>

Geek life



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rings, bracelets, bags, pendants and buttons too. It brings wireless connectivity to wearables and it comes equipped with Bluetooth Low Energy radio, six-axis sensor with accelerometer and gyroscope, pattern matching accelerator for accurate gesture recognition, battery charging technologies as well as 384kB of flash memory, all the basic things that run a wearable device. The Curie is based on the new Quark chip, the Quark SE SoC, which is the company's first purpose-built system on a chip for wearables. It runs on an open source software, Viper that can gather the information to use it for activity recognition and step tracking. The new microcomputer is intended for "always-on" applications in the field of social media, sports and fitness, and the module will be available in the second half of 2015.

With the release of Curie, Intel officially enters into the wearables space, where Qualcomm has already have their own system on a chip for wearable devices. As new product designers explore new areas from the fields of sports, fashion and travel, they are going to eventually incorporate these computer technologies into their products. Intel wants companies to have a product that takes away the complicated bit of developing a wearable device which is usually designing tiny circuit boards or tweaking up the connectivity to other

devices through Blue-tooth. The companies as of now have been sourcing components and software from many different sources or have been developing them in-house, both of which take up a lot of time for even the first prototype to be created. So along with the module, Intel is going to provide its partners with the Intel IQ Software Kit that comes with embedded software that have modules containing smartphone companions and associated cloud capabilities. The kits will

possibly help the companies developing these products in packing the required functionality into their wearable devices. Intel has already been making sensors for wearable devices for over a year now and with Curie, they seem to be wanting to speed up the development, so we could be expecting a horde of Curie-powered wearables once the module starts shipping later this year.

Among all the companies manufacturing wearables, the industry has its eyes set on what Apple would be coming out with, after the unveiling of Apple Watch earlier last year. Even if they aren't capable of making something impressive, it will still be the most talked about gadget throughout the year, only because it's from Apple.

We have seen many interesting concepts surrounding wearables lately. For example, TempTraq is a Bluetooth patch that can send your temperature to your smartphone or AmpStrip that sticks to your chest and sends vital stats to your smartphone. There are numerous concepts and prototypes spread across Kickstarter and other crowd-funding services, and also in labs, but wearables at this stage need to be a polished product, and should be made to go mainstream. One thing to consider is that wearable devices need to be desirable and useful and not just a status symbol. More simple, functional than fashionable. 

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